

5) The Danger of Your Lifestyle

The Slowlane begs you to settle and become a miser. Want to own an exotic car? Forget it. Want to live on a beach? Wishful thinking. If you cannot control your temptations of lifestyle improvement (a nicer home, a nicer car, a nicer meal out), the Slowlane becomes slower and reverses course. The Slowlane *HOPES* your “delayed gratification” moves to “no gratification.”

6) The Danger of the Economy

The Slowlane *HOPES* that your investments will yield a predictable 8% return year after year. You must believe the theory that “buy and hold” works. It doesn’t, because economic busts, recessions, and depressions happen. For example, in 2008–2009, the equity markets lost nearly 60%. If you saved for 15 years and amassed \$100,000, it would now be worth \$40,000. It would take you 14 years at 8% yearly returns just to get back even! That equates to almost 30 YEARS GONE! And this doesn’t account for inflation, which makes your \$100,000 more like \$50,000!

7) The Danger of the Sidewalk

Frustrated Slowlaners often revert to the Sidewalk. Why? Hope over control. When you can’t control time, when you can’t control your job, when you can’t control five days of your life each week, you feel powerless. Emotions of helplessness create an environment ripe for instant gratification and Lifestyle Servitude. A study published in 2008 by the *Journal of Consumer Research* found that when people feel powerless and out of control, they have a strong desire to buy things that convey a high status. Why do they feel powerless? Simple. In the Slowlane, you relinquish control because time is in control and the gates to the Sidewalk reopen. Hope is not a plan.

RESISTANCE IS FUTILE

When you perform an autopsy on the Slowlane you see its true colors: It’s slow, it eats time, and it’s risky. When a Slowlaner realizes the plan isn’t working, he goes into overdrive. Overdrive in the Slowlane is like pushing a car’s accelerator to the floor, hoping its upper speed limits somehow will mystically extend higher, when in fact, the racetrack itself is the problem—not the accelerator.

Yet, a Slowlaner will try to manipulate his weak mathematical universe by trying to make the variables malleable.

- Manipulate intrinsic value by increasing hours worked. (I need to make more money!)
- Manipulate intrinsic value by changing jobs or adding jobs. (I need to get paid more!)